

6.5 THE EUROPEAN DIMENSION

OCR has taken account of the 1988 Resolution of the Council of the European Community in preparing this specification and associated specimen assessments. European examples should be used where appropriate in the delivery of the subject content. Relevant European legislation is identified within the specification where applicable.

This specification is intended to support the European Dimension in Economics. Material relevant to the European economy may be utilised throughout the specification to aid the development of knowledge and understanding, and specific reference is made to the European Union in Section 5.4 The European and International Setting (5.4b, c, d, e).

7 Key Skills

Key Skills are central to successful employment and underpin further success in learning independently. Whilst they are certificated separately, the Key Skills guidance for this qualification has been designed to support the teaching and learning of the content.

Opportunities for developing the generic Key Skills of Communication, Application of Number and Information Technology are indicated through the use of a 'key symbol' in Section 5. The wider Key Skills of Working with Others, Problem Solving and Improving Own Learning and Performance may also be developed through the teaching programmes associated with the specification.

The following matrix indicates those Key Skills for which opportunities to produce evidence exist.

	Communication	Application of Number	IT	Working with Others	Improving Own Learning and Performance	Problem Solving
Level 1	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Level 2	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Detailed opportunities for generating Key Skills evidence through this specification are posted on the OCR website. A summary document for Key Skills coordinators showing ways in which opportunities for Key Skills arise within GCSE courses will be published during 2001.

8 Reading List

The following list of suggested titles is not intended to be exhaustive, nor does inclusion on the list constitute a recommendation of the suitability of the book for the specification. The list details the texts available at the time of the preparation of the specification (May 2000). The possibility exists that more up to date texts which have been prepared for the revised GCSE specifications in Economics may become available.

Teachers will need to use their professional judgement in assessing the suitability of the material contained in this list.

B. Harrison and R. Nutter	GCSE Economics, Longman Study Guide 2nd Edition	Longman ISBN 0582315395
Anderton	Economics for GCSE	Collins ISBN 000327865
Barnes et al	Business and Economics for GCSE	Collins ISBN 0003280136

Web Sites

www.bized.ac.uk – General Business Studies and Economics information.

www.ebea.org.uk – Economics and Business Education Association.

www.ftse.com – Stock market information.

www.open.gov.uk – Government information service.

www.telegraph.co.uk – Daily Telegraph-current affairs.

www.sundaytimes.co.uk – Sunday Times-current affairs.

www.tutor2u.com – Tutor 2u Economics by Geoff Riley.

Further Reading

Borrington and Stimpson	Business Studies now! for G.C.S.E.	John Murray ISBN 0-7195-7222-3.
D.Butler	G.C.S.E. Business Studies	Oxford ISBN 0-19-832797-8.
Bamford et al	Economics for A.S.	Cambridge University Press ISBN 0-521-77728-3

9 Arrangements for Candidates with Special Needs

For candidates who are unable to complete the full assessment or whose performance may be adversely affected through no fault of their own, teachers should consult the *Inter-Board Regulations and Guidance Booklet for Special Arrangements and Special Consideration*.

In such cases, advice should be sought from the OCR Special Requirements team (telephone 01223 552505) as early as possible during the course.

10 Support and In-service Training for Teachers

To support teachers using this specification, OCR will make the following materials and services available:

- a full programme of In-Service training meetings arranged by the Training and Customer Support Division (telephone 01223 552950);
- specimen question papers and mark schemes, available from the Publications department (telephone 0870-870-6622, fax 0870-870-6621);
- past question papers and mark schemes, available from the Publications department (telephone 0870-870-6622, fax 0870-870-6621);
- a report on the examination, compiled by senior examining personnel after each examination session.